Choosing Your Vertical

The Ecosystem, Chapter 2/9 — Revision & Viva-Prep Cheatsheet (English + Roman Urdu)
Source: agentfactory.panaversity.org/docs/ecosystem-choosing-your-vertical

EN: The FDE AF Model explains what a vertical is; this chapter asks WHICH vertical to build. 5 steps, 8 tests, 3 rules you never break. The biggest mistake: a wrong vertical costs a year (a beachhead can change, a vertical cannot).
Roman Urdu: FDE AF Model batata hai vertical kya hoti hai; yeh chapter poochta hai kaunsi vertical banani chahiye. 5 steps, 8 tests, 3 rules jo kabhi mat todo. Sabse bara galti: galat vertical ek saal leta hai (beachhead badal sakta, vertical nahi).

1. Three Rules You Never Break

- **Launch rule:** no vertical launches without a committed domain expert -- without an expert the corpus is just a pile of documents.
- **First-job test:** best first job repeats daily/weekly, has measurable output, an existing supervisor already reviews it, mistakes are fixable.
- **Order rule:** build first, then sell -- a slice of the System of Record must exist (one outcome fully covered) before selling starts.
- **Beachhead vs Vertical:** a beachhead (segment) can change; a vertical (corpus, builder rules, customer relationships) cannot easily.

2. Steps 1-3: Name It, Screen It, Test It

- **Step 1:** name a body of work, not an industry (test: can one person imagine a whole career doing just this?).
- **Step 2 -- Selling-ease screen:** 6 questions, 0-10 score. 6/10+ continue; below 6, exit (service domain or park).
- **Step 3 -- 8 Tests** (need 6.5/8; Test 3 failing ends evaluation regardless of total): Corpus Shape, First Workers, Expert Availability, Governing Rules, Market/Economics, Governance Feasibility, Competitive Position, Regulatory Gate.

3. Steps 4-5: Beachhead + Four Gates

- **Step 4:** pick a beachhead -- clearest knowledge, most checkable Worker, shortest contract-of-success path.
- **Step 5:** 60-90 day fixed window, 4 gates or no launch -- expert signed + rights basis confirmed, THEN the slice built, THEN named sponsor + real quoted numbers.

Key Terms Cheatsheet

One line each — English + Roman Urdu.

Term	English	Roman Urdu
First-job test	The best first Worker job: repeats regularly, measurable, already-reviewed, fixable mistakes.	Behtareen pehli job: repeat hoti, measurable, already-reviewed, fix-able galtiyan.
Beachhead vs Vertical	Beachhead = a segment you can change; Vertical = your corpus/rules/relationships, hard to change.	Beachhead badal sakte ho; vertical (corpus/rules/relationships) badalna mushkil hai.
8 Tests	Corpus Shape, First Workers, Expert Availability, Governing Rules, Market/Economics, Governance Feasibility, Competitive Position, Regulatory Gate.	Corpus Shape, First Workers, Expert Availability, Governing Rules, Market/Economics, Governance Feasibility, Competitive Position, Regulatory Gate.
Thin slice	One professional outcome, fully covered -- not partial breadth.	Ek professional outcome, poori tarah covered -- breadth nahi.

Quick Self-Check

Question	Answer
Why must a vertical never launch without a committed domain expert?	Without an expert, the corpus is just documents -- no one to validate reflexes, judgment, or the rights basis.
What happens if Test 3 (Expert Availability) fails?	Evaluation ends there regardless of the total score -- it's a hard gate, not an average input.
What's the order rule, and why does it matter?	Build first, then sell -- a real thin slice must exist before any sales conversation, because the slice is the proof, not the pitch.
What are the two honest 'exit' paths when the selling-ease screen scores below 6?	Service domain (serve via Layers 1/4 without a vertical trio) or park it entirely.

Where This Leads / Sources

Leads to: Designing the Vertical System of Record (the method for Step 5's slice), The FDE AF Model (Layer 3 trio).

Source: docs/ecosystem-choosing-your-vertical/ (this repo), content originally via Zia Tutor AI connector.